

THE ONTARIO CURRICULUM

GRADES 9–12

Business Studies

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PDF versions of a curriculum include the following information from the [Curriculum and Resources website](#):

- the Program Planning and Assessment and Evaluation sections of the Curriculum and Resources website that apply to all Ontario curriculum, Grades 1–12;
- the Curriculum Context that is specific to a discipline;
- the strands of the curriculum; and
- glossaries and appendices as applicable.

The Ontario Curriculum Grades 9–12: Business Studies,

This curriculum policy supersedes *The Ontario Curriculum, Grades 9 and 10: Business Studies, 2006*. Beginning in the 2024–25 school year, all business studies courses for Grades 9 and 10 will be based on the expectations outlined in this curriculum. All business studies courses for Grades 11 and 12 will continue to be based on [The Ontario Curriculum, Grades 11 and 12: Business Studies, 2006](#). All references to Grades 9 and 10 that appear in that document have been superseded.

Version History:

Version Date	Description
June 2024	New courses issued for Grades 9 and 10 – Grade 9 Building the Entrepreneurial Mindset (BEM1O) and Grade 10 Launching and Leading a Business (BEP2O). Beginning in the 2024–25 school year, Information and Communication Technology in Business, Grade 9 or 10 (BTT1O/BTT2O), and Introduction to Business, Grade 9 or 10 (BBI1O/BBI2O), should not be offered, and the associated course codes will be expired.

Program Planning and Assessment and Evaluation Content

Last updated: June 2023

This content is part of official issued curriculum providing the most up-to-date information (i.e., front matter). This content is applicable to all curriculum documents, Grades 1 to 12. Educators must consider this information to guide the implementation of curriculum and in creating the environment in which it is taught.

This curriculum policy supersedes *The Ontario Curriculum, Grades 9 and 10: Business Studies, 2006*. Beginning in the 2024–25 school year, all business studies courses for Grades 9 and 10 will be based on the expectations outlined in this curriculum. All business studies courses for Grades 11 and 12 will continue to be based on [*The Ontario Curriculum, Grades 11 and 12: Business Studies, 2006*](#). All references to Grades 9 and 10 that appear in that document have been superseded.

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Une publication équivalente est disponible en français sous le titre suivant : Le curriculum de l'Ontario, 9^e et 10^e année – Affaires et commerce, 2024; Le curriculum de l'Ontario, 11^e et 12^e année – Affaires et commerce, 2006.

BEP20 - Launching and Leading a Business, Grade 10

Open

Issued: 2024

This course introduces students to the world of business and what is required to be successful, ethical, and responsible in today's economy. Students will develop the knowledge and skills needed to be an entrepreneur who knows how to respond to local and global market opportunities. Throughout the course, students will explore and understand the responsibility of managing different functions of a business. This includes accounting, marketing, information and communication technology, financial management, human resources, and production.

Prerequisite: None

Disciplines: Introduction to Business Studies and Entrepreneurship

Introduction

Preface

The Ontario Curriculum, Grades 9 and 10: Business Studies, 2024 focuses on foundational business knowledge and skills. It aims to ensure that all students acquire a general understanding of the role and nature of business and entrepreneurship, as they begin to develop business leadership, project management, technological, and communication skills related to bringing their business ideas to life. The curriculum provides a strong foundation both for students who wish to pursue business studies in greater depth and for students who wish to master the business-related knowledge and skills required for everyday life.

In addition to the considerations outlined in this curriculum context, all of the general [“Program Planning”](#) sections on the Curriculum and Resources website apply to this curriculum. Educators should review and implement these general sections, as well as the components that appear below.

Vision and Goals of Business Studies, Grades 9 and 10

The vision of the business studies program in Grades 9 and 10 is for all students to acquire and develop the knowledge and skills related to entrepreneurship and business that will support them in innovating to address the needs and challenges of markets and communities, today and in the future. The program sparks students' curiosity and interest in entrepreneurship and business, and prepares them to apply their education to real-world economic, social, environmental, and ethical challenges and opportunities.

Entrepreneurs and business leaders impact our daily lives. They have the potential to change the way we think, work, and live. These courses support students in understanding the foundational elements of

business studies and in developing the mindset and skills necessary to succeed as entrepreneurs. They foster the critical and creative thinking skills that are needed to conceive of, plan, refine, and develop entrepreneurial ideas and ventures.

This learning will enhance students' ability to achieve success in secondary school, the workplace, skilled trades, postsecondary education or training, and daily life. A central component of this curriculum is developing project management skills and using business-related tools and technology to complete various business-related tasks, from implementing effective sales strategies to analyzing production processes to improve efficiencies. This curriculum also provides students with an opportunity to understand the world of business and how businesses function, and supports students in becoming financially literate citizens.

To succeed in today's society, students need to be effective [problem solvers and critical thinkers](#), able to understand, question, anticipate, and respond to social, economic, environmental, and ethical challenges. Students who pursue careers in business will also need these high-level skills to develop innovative solutions to challenges.

The goals of the Grade 9 and 10 business studies courses are to enable all students to:

- develop the mindset, knowledge, and skills needed to become an entrepreneur who responds to local and global market opportunities;
- develop an understanding of the social, economic, environmental, and ethical considerations associated with entrepreneurship and business;
- develop an understanding of business functions and financial literacy skills;
- develop leadership and project management skills so that they can effectively manage time, resources, and people;
- develop an understanding of how business-related digital technologies can support their business, and use them to complete a variety of tasks and projects;
- communicate effectively and confidently through a variety of business text forms for different purposes and to different audiences;
- apply their learning and make connections to real-world opportunities, other subject areas, and careers in business.

These goals can be achieved in a concrete and practical context through real-world learning activities that combine the acquisition and application of knowledge and skills.

The Importance of Business Studies in the Curriculum

Business has a significant effect on our standard of living and quality of life, and on the environment in which we and future generations will live. Eventually, all students will encounter opportunities and challenges pertaining to business, and they must be prepared to engage in business activity with confidence and competence. Students need to understand how business functions, the role it plays, the

opportunities it generates, the skills it requires, and the impact it can have on their own lives and on society, today and in the future.

The Grade 9 and 10 business studies courses are the first formal opportunity for students to study the world of business. They provide students with a new, practical context for many of the subjects they studied at the elementary level, including mathematics, science and technology, language, and social studies. The courses help them to recognize the relevance of these subjects as they are applied in the world of business – for example, in the study of individuals and diverse communities; in helping people with their needs and challenges; in using financial literacy skills to manage a budget; and in creating products and services that help to improve their quality of life.

Students will be able to apply what they learn in other subject areas to their study of business, as well as to transfer the knowledge and skills they acquire in business studies to their work in other areas.

Leadership

The courses aim to ensure that students acquire a general understanding of the role and nature of business leadership, and the ways in which businesses are structured and managed to achieve organizational goals. Students begin to develop leadership skills related to financial decision making and ethical business practice. Throughout the courses, they learn about different leadership styles that can be used to inspire others, manage challenging situations, and make effective decisions. Having leadership skills empowers students to interact with others confidently and these skills are critical for success in their academic studies and chosen career path.

Project Management

While building their entrepreneurial mindset and gaining an understanding of business concepts, students develop project management skills that will enable them to set goals and key performance indicators, identify and organize tasks, distribute and delegate responsibilities, manage deadlines and progress, assess risks, and lead the project team through the process. Project management skills are critical to achieving entrepreneurial success, and they also support learning in other courses and disciplines. They will support students to succeed in any career path and help them to thrive in a rapidly evolving and fast-paced world.

Developing these skills requires students to engage in a project management process that involves planning and organizing resources to complete both short- and long-term business tasks and projects within a specified time frame and budget. The following diagram summarizes the main stages of the project management process: *initiating*, *planning*, *executing*, *monitoring*, and *closing*, as well as the steps associated with each stage.



The stages in the project management process are described in more detail below. The process will not always be linear, and these stages are meant as a general guide to the process.

Initiating

- **Determine the goals**
 - identify the goals of the project and why they are important
 - define the deliverables and key performance indicators of the project
 - identify the stakeholders
 - obtain approval for the project to proceed (if necessary)

Planning

- **Identify the tasks**
 - define the steps and tasks of the project
 - determine the resources (financial, human, and otherwise) necessary to complete the project
 - create a project plan to delegate tasks and responsibilities and set a schedule for the completion of each task, obtaining consensus from the team
 - analyze possible risks that might come with the project and identify possible ways to overcome challenges

Executing

- **Implement the plan**
 - secure the necessary resources
 - manage change, issues, and risks
 - direct and lead the team with an appropriate leadership style
 - work on creating the deliverables

Monitoring

- **Track progress of the tasks**
 - keep track of the project process
 - monitor the schedule and budget, as necessary
 - conduct status review meetings
 - track and document lessons learned

Closing

- **Deliver project and reflect on the process**
 - ensure completion of the deliverables
 - submit deliverables to stakeholders
 - complete a checklist of responsibilities and deliverables
 - reflect on lessons learned and suggest improvements for the next project

Real-World Connections

The business studies curriculum examines the multifaceted functions and operations of businesses, from small businesses to multinational enterprises. These businesses drive an increasingly global economy, influence the standard and cost of living, impact the nature and number of jobs, and play a role in the career decisions of many secondary school students. Students are motivated and learn best when they understand the relevance of what they are studying. The business studies program provides rich opportunities for relevant, real-world learning experiences and connections. These experiences, such as those found in entrepreneurial activities, reinforce theoretical learning and at the same time provide authentic contexts in which students can apply what they have learned through project-based and experiential learning.

Corporate Social Responsibility

These courses provide students with an introduction to the concept of corporate social responsibility, which is an important aspect of the business studies curriculum. Students who practise corporate social responsibility seek out ethical and respectful ways to engage with the environment and society as a whole, and to enhance both. This involves paying attention to and honouring the diversity of one's

community in order to better serve it, including by being more inclusive and by making the community more accessible to those who are often excluded.

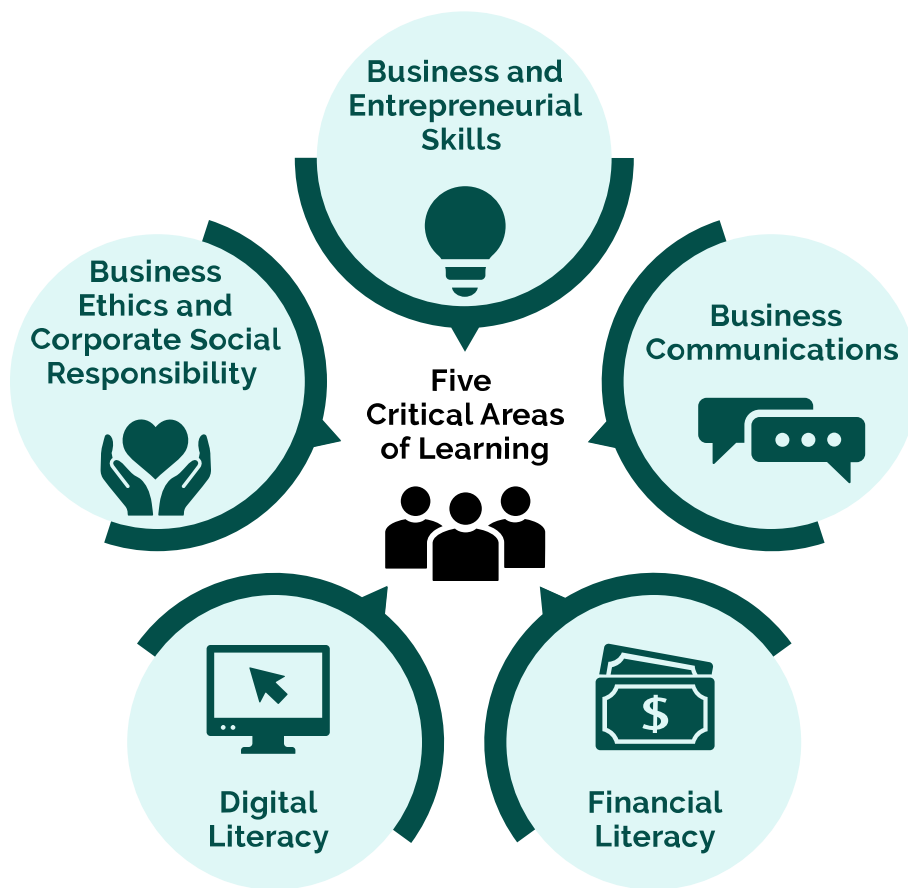
Environmental sustainability, broadly speaking, is the concept of meeting the needs of the present without compromising the ability of future generations to meet their needs. It can be considered in all aspects of business – design ideas, project management, operations, leadership – and is an ever-increasing focus of those in business as society becomes more aware of the impacts of our choices and actions.

Corporate social responsibility is of primary concern to companies and employees around the world. Increased public attention and scrutiny of social responsibility, including environmental sustainability efforts, have provided a major catalyst for many businesses to act in the best interests of the community they serve, and the environment, as well as in the interests of their shareholders. This broadening of scope towards a more holistic view of stakeholders has led many companies to receive positive brand recognition, an increase in customer loyalty, and a better ability to attract and retain top employees.

Students as potential entrepreneurs should recognize the ways they too can be financially responsible, as well as socially and environmentally responsible, so that they benefit themselves, society, the environment, and all their stakeholders.

Five Critical Areas of Learning in Business Studies, Grades 9 and 10

The business studies curriculum in Grades 9 and 10 consists of two courses, both built on the principle that effective learning in all parts of the discipline depends on the development of knowledge and skills in five critical areas: *business and entrepreneurial skills*; *business communications*; *financial literacy*; *digital literacy*; and *business ethics and corporate social responsibility*, as illustrated in the diagram below.



The two courses extend and deepen students' understanding and skills in these critical areas, enabling them to apply the relevant concepts and skills with increasing sophistication to a broad range of business-related issues and problems. Recognizing linkages between these five areas of study strengthens students' understanding of theory and successful practice in the world of business.

Although the specific content of the courses changes from grade to grade, the focus on the five critical areas remains consistent, and lends continuity to student learning.

Each of the five critical areas of learning is associated with related areas of knowledge and skills, as outlined in the following table.

Five Critical Areas of Learning in Business Studies

Critical areas of learning	Related areas of knowledge and skill
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<i>Business and entrepreneurial skills:</i> Knowledge and skills necessary for success in business.	• adaptability and flexibility • business etiquette • business-related digital technologies, tools, and applications • continuous learning • critical and creative thinking • emotional intelligence • employability skills • entrepreneurial skills • financial planning • leadership • negotiating skills • organizational productivity • problem solving • research and inquiry • risk management • strategic planning • team building • teamwork and collaboration • time management
<i>Business communications:</i> Methods, technology, and standards involved in communication within and between businesses (including the use of appropriate terminology, established formats, and emerging technology).	• business terminology • conflict resolution • creativity and originality • design and delivery of presentations • etiquette and protocols in digital communications • formatting and accessibility of documents • global awareness and cultural considerations • literacy skills (listening, speaking, reading, writing, viewing, representing) • persuasion and negotiation skills
<i>Financial literacy:</i> The ability to read, analyze, manage, and communicate financial information for personal and professional purposes.	• analysis of financial statements • financial applications and tools • financial decision making • fundamentals of economics • investment • money management • numeracy skills • taxation • understanding credit

<i>Digital literacy:</i> The ability to use digital technology, communications tools, and/or networks to access, understand, manage, integrate, evaluate, and create information.	• data management and spreadsheets • digital technology use, monitoring, and control • integrated technologies • multimedia tools • privacy, safety, and security related to digital technologies • terminology associated with business-related digital and emerging technologies • troubleshooting and user experience • use of various digital applications • web and other digital design
<i>Business ethics and corporate social responsibility:</i> The understanding and/or determination of social and environmental consequences of business practices on the local, national, and global levels.	• accessibility • accountability • environmental sustainability • equity and diversity • ethical judgement • human rights • intellectual property • leadership and social influence • principles and guidelines for ethical business practice • privacy issues • professional standards • service orientation • social responsibility

Entrepreneurship in Business Studies Education

Entrepreneurship is the act of creating a new business and managing the risks associated with its launch and continued operation. It requires a certain mindset, what is called an *entrepreneurial mindset*, to begin a business and to navigate the various challenges associated with it. (For more on this mindset, see the next section.)

Entrepreneurship can take various forms. For example, change can be led within an organization (*intrapreneurship*) by someone who develops new processes, products, or services, or in society, by someone who is focused on bringing about positive social, systemic, or environmental change (*social entrepreneurship*). In the business studies curriculum, students learn about the variety of paths they may take as entrepreneurs, and they experience entrepreneurship in a way that helps to equip them to solve complex, interconnected, and rapidly evolving challenges.

Through engaging in the act of entrepreneurship, students will encounter various challenges that they will have to navigate using a problem solving process and drawing on their business-related knowledge and other competencies. Skills such as leadership, creativity, critical thinking, communication, organization, and networking are fostered and developed through continuous acts of creating and prototyping, leading and organizing, designing and presenting, and planning and executing. These skills

are essential to entrepreneurship and to a variety of pathways, careers, and opportunities. The need to be enterprising is further emphasized by the exponential growth of global commerce and the economic opportunities it presents. Therefore, students who develop these skills learn how to live and work as creative problem solvers and are more likely to welcome and successfully manage change in a world full of global commerce and economic opportunities.

The experience of entrepreneurship develops [transferable skills](#) that can be used in every aspect of their lives and careers, and adds immense value to their own learning journey. As well, students come to see the rewards that entrepreneurship provides, such as freedom and autonomy in their work, a chance to pursue a career that aligns with their interests, networking with like-minded people, the thrill of leadership and growth, the satisfaction of creating something of value, and a sense of pride and fulfillment, to name a few. It is through the act of entrepreneurship and the experience of developing an entrepreneurial mindset that students will be better prepared for a future world of accelerating change, and pursue a path that best suits them.

The Entrepreneurial Mindset

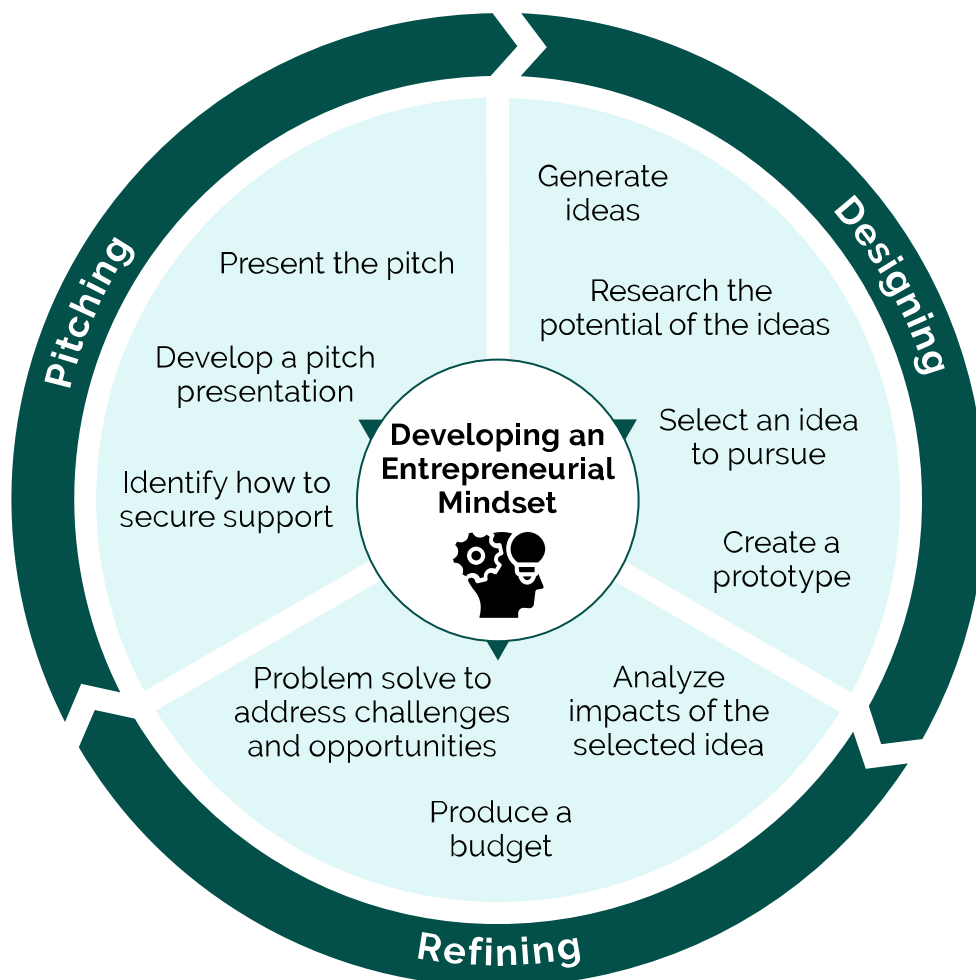
An entrepreneurial mindset is a solutions-oriented set of characteristics and skills and a way of thinking that enables a person to identify opportunities, overcome adversity, learn from mistakes, and succeed in creating a new business. It allows an individual to think critically to solve problems, take on risks, build initiative, be adaptable and flexible, communicate effectively, and work through challenges and setbacks. This mindset requires an openness, so that one can approach developing processes, products, and services in innovative ways. The elements of an entrepreneurial mindset include:

- **being future-oriented:** thinking about the future, the consequences that come with it, and making plans to achieve short- and long-term goals;
- **recognizing opportunities:** seeing problems as opportunities, and potential solutions in the form of new or enhanced products and services;
- **communicating and collaborating:** expressing ideas effectively in different contexts and working with others to achieve a goal;
- **critical thinking and problem solving:** locating, processing, analyzing, and interpreting relevant and reliable information to address complex issues, make informed judgements, and take effective action;
- **anticipating and managing risk:** continuing with a plan and taking steps towards achieving it while identifying and mitigating associated risks;
- **dealing with adversity and preparing for growth:** showing openness to feedback and a willingness to rework ideas and navigate through challenges;
- **creativity:** turning ideas into action in order to meet the needs of others;
- **being a lifelong learner:** continuously learning, growing, and adapting.

Developing an entrepreneurial mindset is a process that occurs over time as students refine their own entrepreneurial ideas. The best results often come when students collaborate and generate a large number of ideas together through divergent thinking and by setting aside constraints. The collaboration should be founded on relationships, respect, reciprocity, and responsibility: students need to feel safe to

share their ideas and work with one another through a creative process. Too much criticism of ideas early in the process will be detrimental to the experience, so they need to be empowered to defer judgement as they create and build on their ideas together.

The following diagram summarizes the main stages in developing an entrepreneurial mindset: *designing*, *refining*, and *pitching*, as well as the steps associated with each stage.



The stages in developing an entrepreneurial mindset are described in more detail below. The process will not always be linear, and these stages are meant as a general guide to the process.

The iterative, non-linear stages in this process are:

Designing

Generate ideas

- develop new ideas or build on others' ideas for a new product or service
- use awareness of different perspectives
- collaborate and set aside constraints that may limit creativity

Research the potential of the ideas

- develop evaluation criteria
- evaluate the potential of various ideas they could pursue

Select an idea to pursue

- choose an idea to pursue that reflects their interests and presents an opportunity
- describe the idea in an accurate, concise, meaningful, and compelling way

Create a prototype

- design a prototype to illustrate the product or service's intended purpose and benefits
- test the ability of the prototype to address the market need or opportunity

Refining

Analyze impacts of the selected idea

- consider the social, economic, environmental, and ethical impacts of their venture idea
- identify various stakeholder perspectives on their product or service

Produce a budget

- identify the potential costs of their entrepreneurial venture
- assess the feasibility of their venture

Problem solve to address challenges and opportunities

- identify challenges and opportunities related to their idea and prototype
- generate solutions to refine both their idea and prototype in order to maximize economic success and positive social, environmental, and ethical outcomes

Pitching

Identify how to secure support

- identify potential supports, including funding opportunities, available to entrepreneurs from a variety of sources

- identify networks and/or individuals who might be interested in collaborating, mentoring, or partnering

Develop a pitch presentation

- identify the elements of a pitch presentation
- gather research and organize information to create a pitch
- create a draft for their pitch
- review, refine, and improve their pitch presentation based on feedback

Present the pitch

- practise their presentation to prepare for the final pitch
- present final pitch to an audience
- gather feedback from the audience, and identify next steps

Through the development of clear learning goals linked to carefully planned assessment of knowledge and skills, teachers can facilitate an experiential learning experience that allows students to engage in constructivist learning. Students can take ownership of this process, work in teams, interact with the school community and the world beyond it, and continuously learn from setbacks and challenges to grow as both students and entrepreneurs.

Developing an entrepreneurial mindset will prepare students to welcome and successfully manage challenges and seize opportunities. Through the development of an entrepreneurial mindset, including problem solving, they learn how to anticipate and address the needs of potential customers, but, more importantly, the needs of their community and beyond. This creates immense social value and helps students to connect their learning with the world around them in a deeper way.

Although having an entrepreneurial mindset is critical to entrepreneurship and business studies, the concepts and lessons learned in developing one will help students achieve success in any pathway they choose, whether it is a career in business or skilled trades, or postsecondary education

Entrepreneurship and Learning from Failure

Entrepreneurial success comes in many forms, and the paths taken to achieve it will vary. Many entrepreneurs experience failure first before achieving eventual success. It is the lessons they learn from this failure and the personal reflection that comes with it that propels them towards newer, better, more innovative, and thus more successful ideas in the future. In both business studies courses, students embark on their own journeys in entrepreneurship and, guided by their teachers, take their own individual paths. In doing so, students will experience various levels of success and failure, whether in developing an idea they can eventually present to an interested audience, or in launching a small entrepreneurial venture. Success at this level should not be measured in terms of the quality of the ideas they develop, or in the sales generated after launching, but in the growth the student demonstrates throughout the process.

Anticipating and managing risk is an important element in the entrepreneurial mindset, as mentioned above. However, some risks, no matter how carefully monitored and managed, can still result in failure. The ability to learn from failure is crucial to entrepreneurship, and students should be continuously supported as they deal with adversity and learn how to navigate through challenges by reflecting on the process and applying the feedback they receive from others. This is what is needed to overcome any type of failure. However, even when students apply concepts and skills effectively, and respond to feedback, their entrepreneurial venture may still end up failing. It is imperative that students, and their teachers, understand that this result does not mean a failure in terms of the learning and therefore the course.

The Program in Business Studies

Overview

The Grade 9 course, *Building the Entrepreneurial Mindset*, and the Grade 10 course, *Launching and Leading a Business*, provide a strong foundation for students who wish to pursue business studies in greater depth and/or who wish to develop a basic understanding of business knowledge and skills that can be applied in many areas of study and in everyday life.

The Grade 9 course, *Building the Entrepreneurial Mindset*, will provide students with an opportunity to learn what makes an entrepreneur thrive and the skills required to succeed in today's business environment. Students will begin to develop their own entrepreneurial mindset, and learn why it's important to take initiative, adapt to change, find creative solutions, and understand the financial considerations of entrepreneurship. This hands-on course will use business software and applications to help students plan and develop their entrepreneurial ideas and learn how to present them to a target audience. Throughout the course, students will enhance their communications skills as well as develop and refine their project management skills, including goal setting, time management, and networking.

The Grade 10 course, *Leading and Launching a Business*, introduces students to the world of business and what is required to be successful, ethical, and responsible in today's economy. Students will develop the knowledge and skills needed to be an entrepreneur who knows how to respond to local and global market opportunities. Throughout the course, students will explore and understand the responsibility of managing different functions of a business. This includes accounting, marketing, information and communication technology, financial management, human resources, and operations.

Courses in Business Studies, Grades 9 to 12

The course information that appears below is in effect starting in the 2024–25 school year. *The Ontario Curriculum, Grades 11 and 12: Business Studies, 2006* remains in effect for those grades. All references to Grades 9 and 10 in that curriculum have been superseded by the 2024 curriculum.

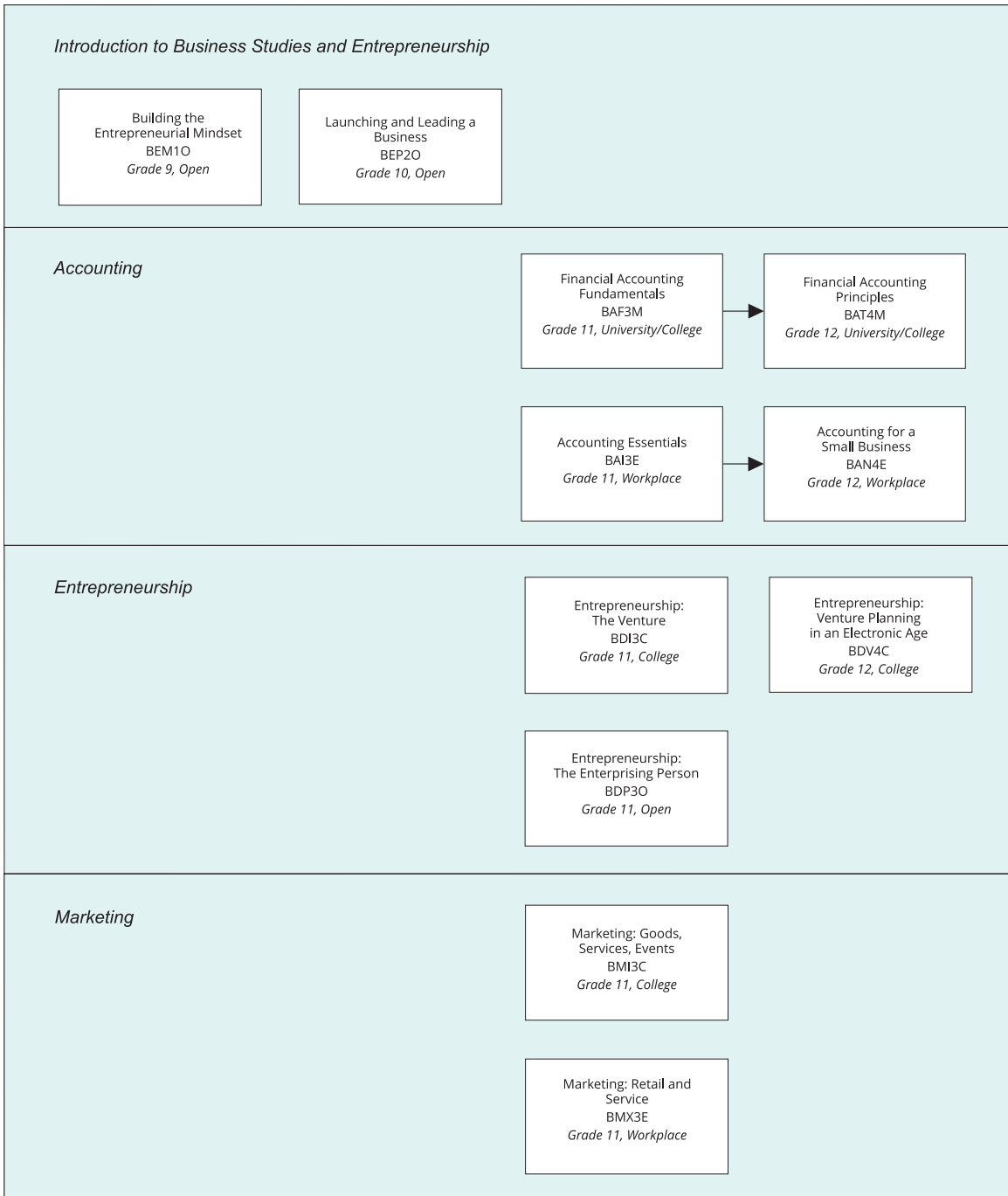
Grades 9 and 10

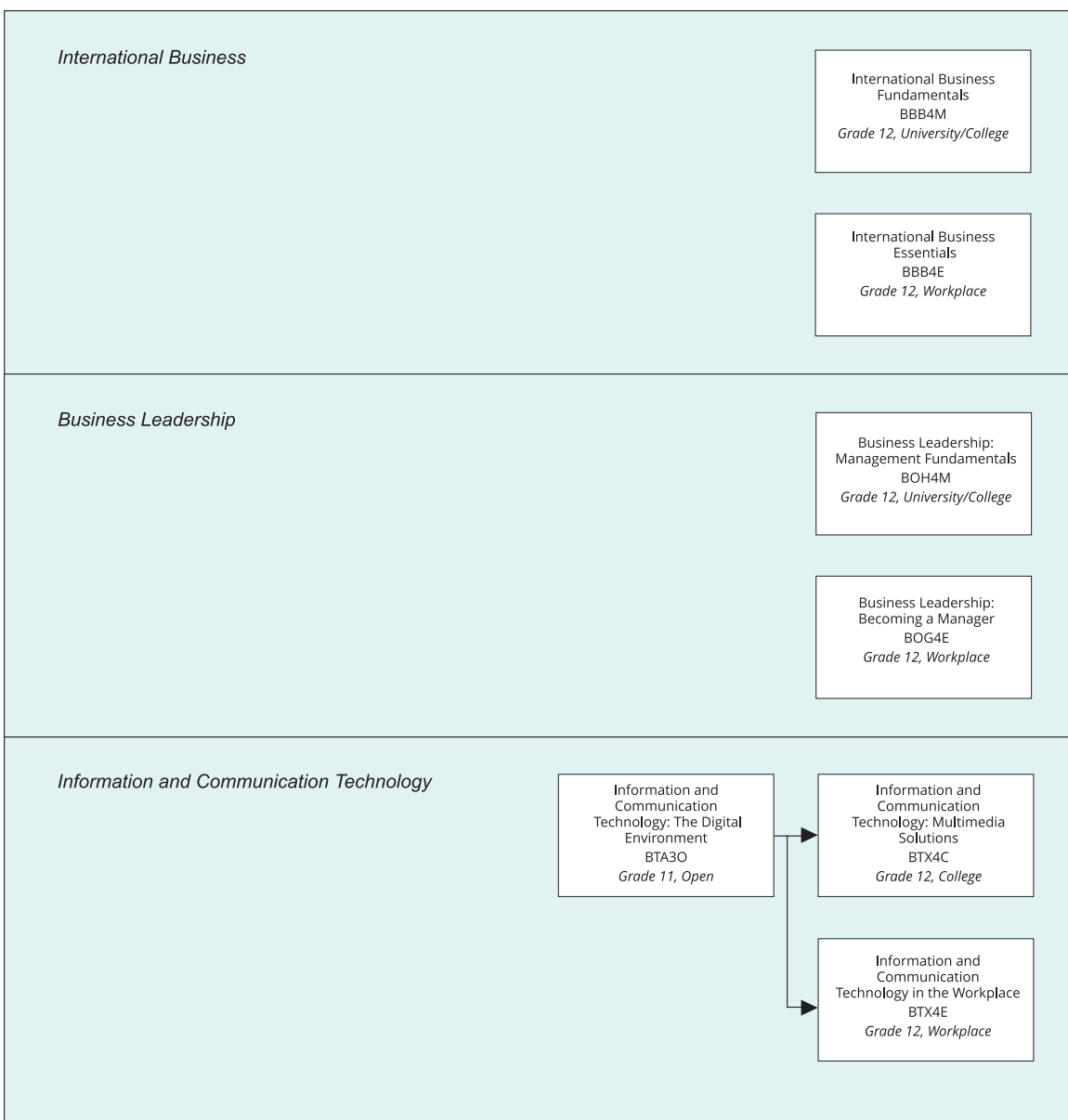
Grade	Course Name	Course Type	Course Code	Prerequisite
9	Building the Entrepreneurial Mindset	Open	BEM10	None
10	Launching and Leading a Business	Open	BEP20	None

Note: Each of the courses listed above is worth one credit.

Prerequisite Chart for Business Studies, Grades 9–12

This chart maps out all the courses in the discipline and shows the links between courses and the possible prerequisites for them. It does not attempt to depict all possible movements from course to course.





The design of the business studies program in Grades 9 and 10 will enable students to select courses that relate to their interests and that prepare them for further study or work in the field of their choosing. Business studies courses are well suited for inclusion in programs that lead to a secondary school diploma with a Specialist High-Skills Major. Whether students eventually work in business or simply use the services of business, the business studies program will provide them with a foundation for making wise choices and informed decisions.

Although courses in business studies are optional, students should keep in mind that any business studies course in the Grade 9–12 program can fulfil the STEM-related compulsory credit requirement for the [Ontario Secondary School Diploma](#).

Half-Credit Courses

The courses outlined in this curriculum are designed to be offered as full-credit courses. However, they may also be delivered as half-credit courses. Half-credit courses, which require a minimum of fifty-five hours of scheduled instructional time, must adhere to the following conditions:

- The two half-credit courses created from a full course must together contain all of the expectations of the full course.
- Students must successfully complete both parts of the course if it is to be used as a prerequisite for another course. The expectations for the two half-credit courses must be divided in a manner that best enables students to achieve the required knowledge and skills in the allotted time.
- A course that is a prerequisite for another course may be offered as two half-credit courses, but a student must successfully complete both parts of the course to fulfil the prerequisite. (Students are not required to complete both parts unless the course is a prerequisite for another course they wish to take.)
- The title of each half-credit course must include the designation Part 1 or Part 2. A half-credit (0.5) will be recorded in the credit-value column of both the report card and the Ontario Student Transcript.

Boards will report all half-credit courses to the ministry annually in the School October Report.

Curriculum Expectations

The expectations identified for the Grade 9 and 10 courses describe the skills and knowledge that students are expected to acquire, demonstrate, and apply in their class work and tasks, in demonstrations, and in other various other activities on which their achievement is assessed and evaluated.

Mandatory learning is described in the overall and specific expectations of the curriculum.

Two sets of expectations – overall expectations and specific expectations – are listed for each *strand*, or broad area of the curriculum. The strands in these two courses are lettered A through C, and A through D, respectively. *Taken together, the overall and specific expectations represent the mandated curriculum.*

The *overall expectations* describe in general terms the knowledge and skills that students are expected to demonstrate by the end of each course. The *specific expectations* describe the expected knowledge and skills in greater detail. The specific expectations are organized under numbered subheadings, each of which indicates the strand and the overall expectation to which the group of specific expectations corresponds (e.g., “B2” indicates that the group relates to overall expectation 2 in Strand B). This organization is not meant to imply that the expectations in any one group are achieved independently of the expectations in the other groups, nor is it intended to imply that learning associated with the expectations happens in a linear, sequential way. The numbered headings are used merely as an organizational structure to help teachers focus on particular aspects of knowledge, concepts, and skills as they develop various lessons and learning activities for students.

Teacher Supports

Specific expectations are often accompanied by supports such as examples, teacher prompts, and/or instructional tips.¹ Examples are meant to clarify the requirement specified in the expectation, illustrating the kind of skill or knowledge, the specific area of learning, the depth of learning, and/or the level of complexity that the expectation entails. Teacher prompts are sample guiding questions and considerations that can lead to discussions and promote deeper understanding. Instructional tips suggest instructional strategies and authentic contexts for the effective modelling, practice, and application of business studies knowledge and skills.

Teacher supports, such as examples, teacher prompts, and instructional tips, are optional supports that are strategically designed, crafted, and situated to support teachers in understanding the depth and breadth of an expectation, so that they can develop their own supports reflecting a similar level of complexity. Whatever the specific ways in which the requirements outlined in the expectations are implemented in the classroom, they must be inclusive and, wherever possible, reflect the diversity of the student population, including the cultural diversity of students and the accommodations students with special education needs require.

Strands in the Grade 9 Business Studies Course

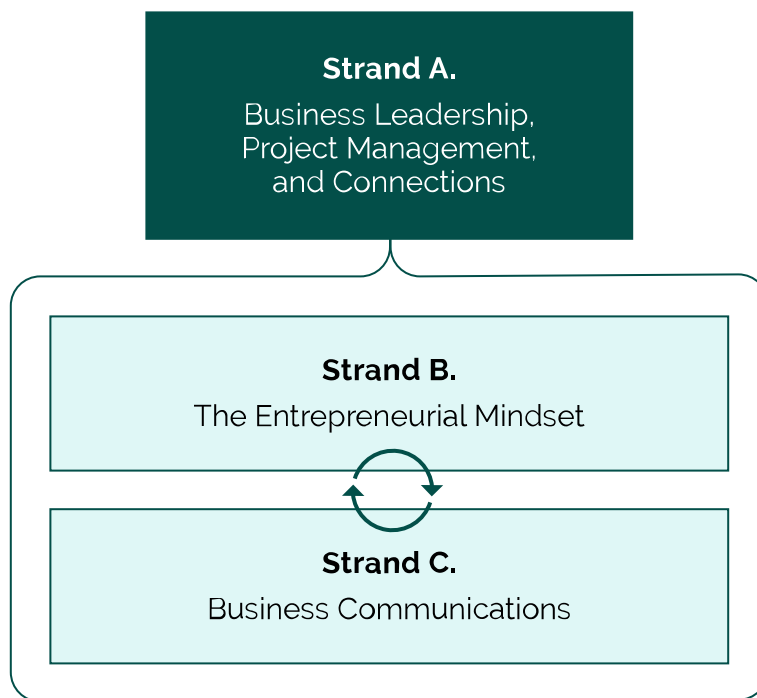
The expectations in the Grade 9 course are organized into three distinct but related strands:

- A. Business Leadership, Project Management, and Connections
- B. The Entrepreneurial Mindset
- C. Business Communications

Strand A is an overarching strand that focuses on the business leadership, project management, and technological skills that will enable students to investigate concepts and integrate knowledge and skills from the other two strands. It also encourages students to examine practical applications of business knowledge and skills, including in careers, and the contributions of successful entrepreneurs.

In Strands B and C, students integrate Strand A expectations as they begin to develop an entrepreneurial mindset and business communication skills. The chart below illustrates the relationship between Strand A and the other two strands.

¹ The teacher supports will be made available at a later date, after the issuing of the curriculum expectations and the curriculum context.



Strand A. Business Leadership, Project Management, and Connections

Strand A focuses on students developing an understanding of business leadership styles and project management skills. They use this learning, along with technological tools, to support the completion of business-related tasks and projects. (For more on project management, see the subsection "Project Management" under "The Importance of Business Studies in the Curriculum".)

In this strand, students also learn how business skills and knowledge, including financial literacy, can be applied in other subject areas, as well as in job skills programs, and can be used to pursue real-world opportunities. Students create and maintain a portfolio that illustrates their business competencies and personal growth as an entrepreneur. (For more on this, see the subsection "The Portfolio of Learning for Business Studies" under "Program Planning and Cross-Curricular and Integrated Learning".)

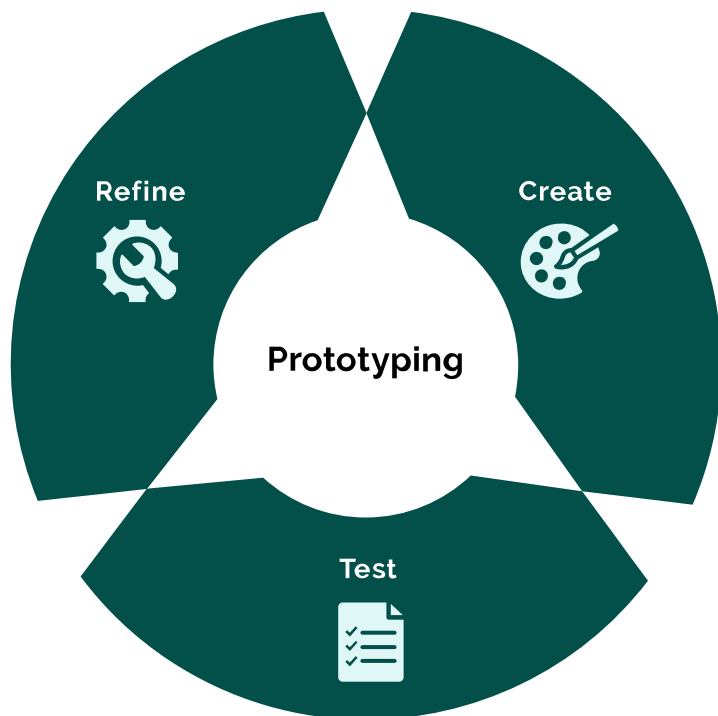
Strand A also involves students exploring how successful entrepreneurs from local, Canadian, and global communities have addressed social, economic, environmental, and ethical issues. Students analyze many of the challenges entrepreneurs face and identify supports available to better assist them.

Strand B. The Entrepreneurial Mindset

Strand B focuses on students developing an understanding of the entrepreneurial mindset and the skills associated with it. Students identify different types of businesses; the characteristics of various entrepreneurs, including First Nations, Métis, and Inuit entrepreneurs; and the experiences that led these entrepreneurs to innovate and create new products and services. Students reflect on their own

entrepreneurial potential and create a plan to build their skills. (For more on developing an entrepreneurial mindset, see the subsection "The Entrepreneurial Mindset" under "Entrepreneurship in Business Studies Education".)

Using a design process, students build and refine an idea for a new product or service that reflects their interests. Part of this process involves creating a prototype, which could be a storyboard, to test their idea, gather feedback on it, and refine it. Below is a diagram illustrating how a prototype for an idea can be created:



Once their idea and the prototype have been further refined using a problem solving process, they produce a simple budget to assess the financial outlook for their potential entrepreneurial venture. Lastly, students prepare and present a pitch presentation, gathering feedback from the audience in order to determine next steps.

Strand C. Business Communications

Strand C focuses on students creating effective business texts, including digital and media texts. They plan, research, and develop business communication materials for a variety of purposes and audiences, using clear and inclusive language as well as appropriate business terminology, text forms, and digital tools and techniques. They select appropriate and accessible fonts, colours, and visual elements to clarify and enhance the graphic design of their messages. They revise their texts by editing and proofreading them and by seeking and selectively using feedback. Lastly, they publish their texts in an

accessible format using appropriate digital tools and techniques, and present them to an audience using appropriate oral presentation tools and techniques.

Strands in the Grade 10 Business Studies Course

The expectations in the Grade 10 course are organized into four distinct but related strands:

A. Business Leadership, Project Management, and Connections

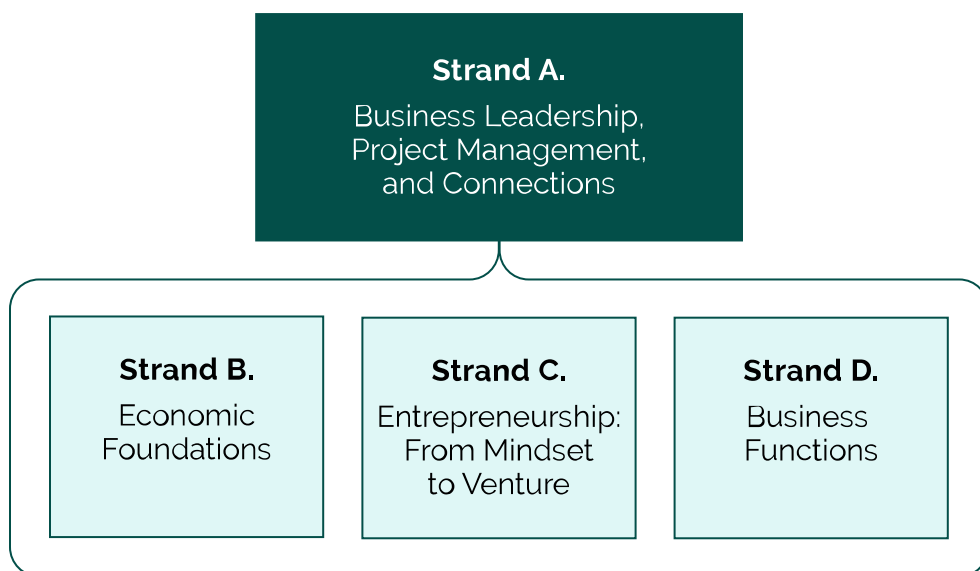
B. Economic Foundations

C. Entrepreneurship: From Mindset to Venture

D. Business Functions

Strand A is an overarching strand that focuses on the business leadership, project management, and technological skills that will enable students to investigate concepts and integrate knowledge and skills from the other two strands. It also encourages students to examine practical applications of business knowledge and skills, including in careers, and the contributions of successful entrepreneurs.

In Strands B, C, and D, students integrate Strand A expectations as they explore the basic economic foundations of business, pursue an entrepreneurial venture, and learn about different business functions, including finance, required to run a successful business. The chart below illustrates the relationship between Strand A and the other three strands.



Strand A. Business Leadership, Project Management, and Connections

Strand A focuses on students developing an understanding of business leadership styles and project management skills. They use this learning, along with technological tools, to support the completion of business-related tasks and projects. (For more on project management, see the subsection "Project Management" under "The Importance of Business Studies in the Curriculum".)

In this strand, students also learn how business skills and knowledge, including financial literacy, can be applied in other subject areas, as well as in job skills programs, and can be used to pursue real-world opportunities. Students create and maintain a portfolio that illustrates their business competencies and personal growth as an entrepreneur. (For more on this, see the subsection "The Portfolio of Learning for Business Studies" under "Program Planning and Cross-Curricular and Integrated Learning".)

Strand A also involves students exploring how successful entrepreneurs from local, Canadian, and global communities have addressed social, economic, environmental, and ethical issues. Students analyze many of the challenges entrepreneurs face and identify supports available to better assist them.

Strand B. Economic Foundations

Strand B focuses on the economic principles of small business. Students explore how businesses respond to economic cycles and market forces, how the needs and wants of consumers affect their behaviour, and how businesses respond to consumer behaviour.

Students learn about how different competitive market structures and trade relationships affect business activities in Canada and why different levels of government, as well as non-governmental bodies, may intervene in markets to make them more fair, competitive, and responsible.

In Strand B, students also identify the different types of businesses in Canada and their role in the economy. Students explore the actions taken by various businesses in Canada to become more socially responsible and/or sustainable, including how Canadian businesses are working collaboratively and building respectful relationships with Indigenous entrepreneurs, organizations, and businesses, as well as First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals and communities, and how this contributes to reconciliation. (For more on this, see the subsection "Corporate Social Responsibility" under "The Importance of Business Studies in the Curriculum".)

Strand C. Entrepreneurship: From Mindset to Venture

Strand C focuses on students planning and launching their own entrepreneurial venture. Their ventures may be launched online through a website or social media platform, or through a bricks-and-mortar pop-up shop or market, or through an in-person service.

They first develop an understanding of an entrepreneurial mindset and how their past experiences can help them to create and innovate new products and services. Next, they apply a design process to identify an idea that meets a market opportunity in their community, and then use a problem solving process to refine this idea, taking into account any social, economic, environmental, and ethical impacts.

(For more on developing an entrepreneurial mindset, see the subsection "The Entrepreneurial Mindset" under "Entrepreneurship in Business Studies Education".)

Students then establish the target market for their proposed venture; identify the logistics, resources, and requirements necessary to launch it; develop a brand; determine key performance indicators for measuring success; and monitor important financial considerations, including a start-up budget and break-even analysis.

In Strand C, students explore opportunities for support, including funding, available in their community to help launch their venture. Whichever type of venture they choose, they launch it and lead it towards achieving their identified goals and key performance indicators, and throughout the process, they focus on adopting ethical sales strategies and respectful and accessible customer service approaches.

Strand D. Business Functions

Strand D focuses on business functions, including operations, marketing, accounting, and management of human resources. Students explore the process of producing a product or delivering a service and develop a production plan for their venture.

In this strand, students begin to develop an understanding of the “three Cs” (company, customer, and competition”) and the “four Ps” (product, price, place, and promotion”) of marketing, and develop a marketing mix for their venture.

In Strand D, students also explore the role and importance of both financial and management accounting to the entrepreneurial process and how non-financial reporting can further support the development and growth of a small business. They also learn about the role of management in supporting a team of employees, including a manager’s ethical, moral, and legal responsibilities and considerations.

Program Planning and Cross-Curricular and Integrated Learning

Educators consider many factors when planning a business studies program that cultivates the best possible environment in which all students can maximize their learning. This section highlights important areas of focus that educators should consider, including areas of cross-curricular and integrated learning, as they plan effective and accessible business studies programs. In addition, all of the general [“Program Planning”](#) sections on the Curriculum and Resources website apply to this curriculum.

Instructional Approaches in the Grade 9 and 10 Business Studies courses

Instruction in Grade 9 and 10 business studies can support all students in acquiring the knowledge, skills, and habits of mind that they need in order to: investigate innovations, opportunities, and challenges;

develop business leadership and entrepreneurial thinking practices; design and develop entrepreneurial ideas; think critically; and work cooperatively on exciting projects.

Universal Design for Learning (UDL) and Differentiated Instruction (DI)

Students in every classroom, including business studies, vary in their identities, experiences, personal interests, learning profiles, and readiness to learn new concepts and skills. Universal Design for Learning (UDL) and differentiated instruction (DI) are robust and powerful approaches to designing assessment and instruction to engage all students in business studies tasks that develop conceptual understanding. UDL and DI can be used in combination to help teachers respond effectively to the strengths and needs of all students.

The aim of the UDL framework is to assist teachers in designing business studies learning opportunities and environments that provide all students with inclusive, flexible, and equitable access to the curriculum. Teachers in business studies take into account students' diverse learner profiles to design lessons and tasks that offer individual choice, ensuring relevance and authenticity, providing graduated levels of challenge, and fostering collaboration in the learning environment. Business studies teachers should also represent business concepts and information in multiple ways to help students to become resourceful and knowledgeable learners and to allow students to engage in learning through a variety of formats (e.g., case studies, hand-on activities, guest speakers) and contexts (e.g., individual, pair, group, and distance learning).

Students have a diverse set of learning needs and range of cultural experiences and identities. Teachers incorporate culturally relevant teaching, centring students' cultural backgrounds, into learning experiences to ensure that learning is authentic, meaningful, and relevant to students. For example, teachers could use UDL principles to make space for First Nations, Métis, and Inuit perspectives and contributions in the learning for all students, including Indigenous students. These planned opportunities facilitate the exploration of various meaningful and engaging forms of resources, including audio recordings, digital archives, virtual exhibits, or interviews with First Nations, Métis, and Inuit community members, which both inspire and build an understanding of diverse cultures.

Designing business assignments and tasks through UDL from the start enables students to find their own entry point to the learning. Teachers use a tiered approach to ensure responsive, timely, and effective instruction that improves student learning while maintaining high expectations and rigour for all students. To support learners as they focus strategically on their learning goals, teachers create an environment in which learners can express themselves using a range of strengths. For example, teachers can vary the ways in which students can respond and demonstrate their understanding of business concepts and skills, such as by allowing them the flexibility to record a podcast, make a video, create a poster, or design an infographic to include in their entrepreneurial pitches. Teachers can also support students in developing and demonstrating project management skills connected to their learning in business studies assignments and projects.

While UDL provides teachers with broad principles for planning instruction and learning in business studies for a diverse group of students, differentiated instruction (DI) allows them to address specific skills and learning needs on a case-by-case basis. DI is student centred and involves a strategic blend of

whole-class, small-group, and individual learning activities to suit students' differing strengths, interests, and levels of readiness to learn.

Attending to students' varied readiness for learning in business studies is an important aspect of differentiated instruction. Students need support in aiming higher, building their confidence, and co-creating solutions of increasing complexity. To make some concepts more accessible, teachers can employ strategies such as offering students choice and providing open-ended problems that are based on situations relevant to their everyday lives.

Universal Design for Learning and differentiated instruction are integral aspects of an inclusive business studies program that has the goal of achieving equity in business education. Inclusion, accessibility, and setting high expectations, in addition to planning and delivering lessons using UDL and DI, benefits all students, including students receiving special education programs and/or services. For students with Individual Education Plans (IEPs), educators should be part of developing/updating the IEP and are required to provide the accommodations as written in the IEP, which are based on the strengths and needs of the individual student. More information on these approaches can be found in the ministry publication [*Learning for All: A Guide to Effective Assessment and Instruction for All Students, Kindergarten to Grade 12 \(2013\)*](#).

Additional Instructional Approaches for Business Studies

Students learn best when they are engaged in a variety of ways of learning. Business studies courses lend themselves to a wide range of approaches in that they require students to discuss issues, solve problems using digital applications, participate in business simulations, conduct research, think critically, work cooperatively, and make business decisions. When students are engaged in active and experiential learning strategies, they tend to retain knowledge for longer periods and to develop meaningful skills. Active and experiential learning strategies also enable students to apply their knowledge and skills to real-life issues and situations.

Some of the teaching and learning strategies that are suitable to material taught in business studies are the use of case studies and simulations, teamwork, brainstorming, mind mapping, problem solving, decision making, independent research, personal reflection, seminar presentations, direct instruction, portfolios, and hands-on applications. In combination, such approaches promote the acquisition of knowledge, foster positive attitudes towards learning, and encourage students to become lifelong learners.

Teachers must provide a wide range of activities and assignments that encourage mastery of basic concepts and development of inquiry/research skills. To make their programs interesting and relevant, they must help students to relate the knowledge and skills gained to issues and situations in the business world. It is essential to emphasize the relationship of business studies to the world outside the school to help students recognize that what they are studying is not just a school subject but a reality that profoundly affects their lives, their communities, and the world. For example, opportunities for students to lead socially responsible efforts may be limited due to resources, time, or connections, but attempts and efforts should be made. Whether it is donating revenue from sales to community causes, organizing small fundraising events, establishing a social or environmental mission with clear goals, or

collaborating with established socially responsible businesses, such activities can make a lasting impact on the students or anyone they interact with. Students will benefit greatly from any experiential learning opportunity associated with corporate social responsibility and will continue to grow into the ethical and socially responsible leaders of tomorrow.

Students' attitudes towards business studies can have a significant effect on their achievement of expectations. Teaching methods and learning activities that encourage students to recognize the value and relevance of what they are learning will go a long way towards motivating students to work and learn effectively. In addition, the diversity of subjects and approaches represented in the business curriculum will allow students to find courses that are well suited to their particular learning styles and interests.

In all courses, consideration should be given to including student conferences; visits from a range of guest speakers, including entrepreneurial role models, with diverse backgrounds and experiences; mentorship opportunities with community business leaders; case studies or project proposals for community business initiatives; and trips to local businesses. Students develop a better understanding of various aspects of the study of business when they can see and experience actual examples of what they are studying. Such experiences also give them a better appreciation of the unique features of the business communities that affect their daily lives.

The complex nature of business today, influenced by the restructuring of the economy, rapid advances in emerging technologies, and the globalization of the marketplace, requires that students be given varied opportunities to learn about current business realities and practices. By ensuring that students engage in experiential learning and real-world applications, teachers can help them develop the practical, current business knowledge and skills they need.

The Grade 9 and 10 business studies courses have been designed for use throughout the province, and the expectations in them can be adapted to reflect the local business environment. They also take into account the constant changes in technology and the global economy, enabling teachers to develop lessons that are creative, dynamic, and challenging for students. The curriculum expectations encourage the use of business simulations, and digital technologies, tools, and applications. They also focus on employability skills, thereby building a foundation for the development of school-to-work transition programs.

The Portfolio of Learning for Business Studies

In both the Grade 9 and 10 business studies courses, students will curate a portfolio to reflect on the knowledge and skills they have developed, including their business competencies and growth as an entrepreneur. The portfolio is a collection of samples of student work that the student, with teacher support, carefully selects and adds to on an ongoing basis to track what the student has learned throughout the course. These samples may include, but need not be limited to, drafts, recordings, and/or videos of their works in progress, such as business communications, creative sketches of their brand, prototypes, and working budgets.

A portfolio is an opportunity for students to showcase their technical skills, critical and creative thinking, problem solving, and ability to adapt, be responsive, and innovate. It provides students with an opportunity to work towards proficiency of concepts and skills in business studies and to continuously reflect on the learning and growth they have experienced as business studies students and entrepreneurs. It is a fundamental aspect of learning in both courses.

Descriptive feedback provided to students on their work is essential, as portfolios are good mechanisms for students to reflect on, monitor, and adjust their learning to make improvements. This feedback may include assessment by their peers and teachers. Students should also regularly assess their own competencies and skills. To do this, teachers should provide them with structured opportunities to engage in self-reflection and metacognition – for example, to reflect on their strengths and areas for improvement and on strategies for developing their business competencies and skills. These opportunities, along with ongoing teacher feedback, should be woven into the learning throughout each course. In this way, assessment by both teacher and student can be used to enhance the development of students' planning, processing, thinking, communication, and leadership skills in the five critical areas of business studies learning – business and entrepreneurial skills, business communications, financial literacy, digital literacy, and business ethics and corporate social responsibility.

The Role of Digital Technologies

Business-related digital technologies provide a range of tools and applications that can significantly extend and enrich teachers' instructional strategies and support students' learning in business studies. These digital tools include simulations, multimedia resources, databases, spreadsheets, and computer-assisted learning modules. Teachers can use these tools and resources both for whole-class instruction and to design programs that meet diverse student needs. Digital technologies, tools, and applications, both existing and emerging, can also be used to connect students to other schools, at home and abroad, and to bring the global community into the local classroom.

Digital resources and networks also allow secondary school students to conduct more far-ranging and authentic research than ever before. These resources are powerful learning tools, and entrepreneurs are increasingly moving towards having a strong online presence, both in terms of raising awareness about their businesses and to facilitate e-commerce. At the same time, digital connectivity has become ubiquitous in everyday life. Collaboration and networking across online networks and platforms are increasingly important to connecting with consumers and staying relevant. When students are engaging online, they must be made aware of issues of privacy, safety, and ethical and responsible use, as well as of how online platforms can be used to promote hatred, so that they can better protect themselves online.

Applications such as website design platforms, spreadsheets, word processors, and presentation and multimedia software can be used to enhance student learning in all business studies courses. They are an essential tool for learning. In the Grade 9 and 10 business studies courses, students acquire skills in the use of word processing, spreadsheets, digital publishing, website design, and presentation and multimedia software that meet current business and accessibility standards and that are transferable to other courses as well as to the workplace. Business-related technologies are integrated into the business

studies curriculum in a way that mirrors the dynamic environment in which business is conducted today, creating an authentic and relevant learning environment for students.

Furthermore, as new technologies emerge and are implemented in schools, and as existing ones improve, the variety of tools, applications, and supports for students will continually change. The benefits of these emerging technologies will vary; however, each will provide the possibility of new horizons for students and help to build digital literacy, critical thinking, creativity, and problem solving skills. By guiding students and helping them explore the variety of emerging digital technologies available to them, teachers can encourage students to think critically about the use of digital technologies, including about their benefits, limitations, costs, and risks. Students can then build their digital literacy skills and select and use the most appropriate tools for the task at hand.

Lastly, technology can greatly assist those with accessibility needs, since the different services and devices can increase, maintain, or improve functional capabilities for students with disabilities. Whether it is a word processor, laptop, recording device, or special type of software, assistive technology can improve academic performance and provide greater independence and more opportunities for students with disabilities or varying learning needs.

Financial Literacy

Financial literacy education provides students with the preparation they need to make responsible and informed financial decisions with competence and confidence. The Grade 9 and 10 business studies courses provide a number of opportunities for students to develop skills and knowledge related to financial literacy.

As students develop their own entrepreneurial mindset, they refine their critical thinking skills related to financial literacy. For example, they create a potential budget for an entrepreneurial idea. They also develop an understanding of how financial literacy can support learning in other subject areas and in job skills programs available at their school or board.

Students learn about the economic issues associated with starting an entrepreneurial venture, and how entrepreneurs have responded over time to address these issues. They develop an understanding of the importance of responsibly managing and mitigating financial risk. They learn to take budgetary constraints into account as they assess client and consumer needs and identify solutions appropriate to specific contexts and situations.

As part of learning to become responsible entrepreneurs in a global economy, students carefully consider the economic implications of their choices on their clients and consumers. They also consider the impact of their choices on society in general, not only in terms of job creation and economic growth, but in terms of social and global change.

Assessment and Evaluation of Student Achievement

[*Growing Success: Assessment, Evaluation, and Reporting in Ontario Schools, First Edition, Covering Grades 1 to 12, 2010*](#) sets out the Ministry of Education’s assessment, evaluation, and reporting policy. The policy aims to maintain high standards, improve student learning, and benefit all students, parents², and teachers in elementary and secondary schools across the province. Successful implementation of this policy depends on the professional judgement of teachers at all levels as well as their high expectations of all students, and on their ability to work together and to build trust and confidence among parents and students.

Major aspects of assessment, evaluation, and reporting policy are summarized in the general “[Assessment and Evaluation](#)” section that applies to all curricula. The key tool for assessment and evaluation in business studies, Grades 9 and 10 – the achievement chart – is provided below.

The Achievement Chart for Business Studies, Grades 9 and 10

The achievement chart identifies four [categories of knowledge and skills](#) and four [levels of achievement](#) in business studies, Grades 9 and 10. (For important background, see “[Content Standards and Performance Standards](#)” in the general Assessment and Evaluation section.)

Knowledge and Understanding – Subject-specific content acquired in each course (knowledge), and the comprehension of its meaning and significance (understanding)

Categories	50–59% (Level 1)	60–69% (Level 2)	70–79% (Level 3)	80–100% (Level 4)
Knowledge of content (e.g., facts, terms, definitions, processes)	The student demonstrates limited knowledge of content.	The student demonstrates some knowledge of content.	The student demonstrates considerable knowledge of content.	The student demonstrates thorough knowledge of content.
Understanding of content (e.g., concepts, principles, theories, processes, and technologies)	The student demonstrates limited understanding of content.	The student demonstrates some understanding of content.	The student demonstrates considerable understanding of content.	The student demonstrates thorough understanding of content.

Thinking – The use of critical and creative thinking skills and/or processes

Categories	50–59% (Level 1)	60–69% (Level 2)	70–79% (Level 3)	80–100% (Level 4)
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² The word *parent(s)* is used on this website to refer to parent(s) and guardian(s). It may also be taken to include caregivers or close family members who are responsible for raising the child.

Use of planning skills (e.g., focusing research, gathering information, generating ideas, selecting strategies, organizing projects, developing plans)	The student uses planning skills with limited effectiveness.	The student uses planning skills with some effectiveness.	The student uses planning skills with considerable effectiveness.	The student uses planning skills with a high degree of effectiveness.
Use of processing skills (e.g., analyzing, interpreting, assessing, reasoning, selecting digital tools and technologies, evaluating, integrating, synthesizing, examining a variety of perspectives, seeking feedback, forming conclusions)	The student uses processing skills with limited effectiveness.	The student uses processing skills with some effectiveness.	The student uses processing skills with considerable effectiveness.	The student uses processing skills with a high degree of effectiveness.
Use of critical/creative thinking processes (e.g., evaluation of business situations and ideas, problem solving, learning from feedback and research, ethical decision making, detecting bias)	The student uses critical/creative thinking processes with limited effectiveness.	The student uses critical/creative thinking processes with some effectiveness.	The student uses critical/creative thinking processes with considerable effectiveness.	The student uses critical/creative thinking processes with a high degree of effectiveness.

Communication – The conveying of meaning through various forms

Categories	50–59% (Level 1)	60–69% (Level 2)	70–79% (Level 3)	80–100% (Level 4)
Expression and organization of ideas and information (e.g., clear expression, logical organization, appropriate design) in oral, non-verbal, visual, and/or written forms, including digital and media forms (e.g., presentations, charts, graphs, tables, maps, prototypes, storyboards, web pages, spreadsheets, online networks, financial statements, letters, memos, reports)	The student expresses and organizes ideas and information with limited effectiveness.	The student expresses and organizes ideas and information with some effectiveness.	The student expresses and organizes ideas and information with considerable effectiveness.	The student expresses and organizes ideas and information with a high degree of effectiveness.

Communication for different audiences (e.g., team members; business partners, managers, and leaders; diverse communities) and purposes (e.g., to inform, to persuade, to inspire, to motivate) in oral, non-verbal, visual, and/or written forms, including digital and media forms	The student communicates for different audiences and purposes with limited effectiveness.	The student communicates for different audiences and purposes with some effectiveness.	The student communicates for different audiences and purposes with considerable effectiveness.	The student communicates for different audiences and purposes with a high degree of effectiveness.
Use of conventions, vocabulary, and terminology of the discipline in oral, non-verbal, visual, and/or written forms, including digital and media forms	The student uses conventions, vocabulary, and terminology of the discipline with limited effectiveness.	The student uses conventions, vocabulary, and terminology of the discipline with some effectiveness.	The student uses conventions, vocabulary, and terminology of the discipline with considerable effectiveness.	The student uses conventions, vocabulary, and terminology of the discipline with a high degree of effectiveness.

Application – The use of knowledge and skills to make connections within and between various contexts

Categories	50–59% (Level 1)	60–69% (Level 2)	70–79% (Level 3)	80–100% (Level 4)
Application of knowledge and skills (e.g., concepts, processes, ethical standards, use of digital tools and technologies) in familiar contexts	The student applies knowledge and skills in familiar contexts with limited effectiveness.	The student applies knowledge and skills in familiar contexts with some effectiveness.	The student applies knowledge and skills in familiar contexts with considerable effectiveness.	The student applies knowledge and skills in familiar contexts with a high degree of effectiveness.
Transfer of knowledge and skills (e.g., selection and use of digital tools and technologies, ethical standards, concepts, processes) to new contexts	The student transfers knowledge and skills to new contexts with limited effectiveness.	The student transfers knowledge and skills to new contexts with some effectiveness.	The student transfers knowledge and skills to new contexts with considerable effectiveness.	The student transfers knowledge and skills to new contexts with a high degree of effectiveness.

Making connections within and between various contexts (e.g., connections between business studies and personal experiences, career opportunities, community and global challenges and perspectives; cross-curricular and multidisciplinary connections)	The student makes connections within and between various contexts with limited effectiveness.	The student makes connections within and between various contexts with some effectiveness.	The student makes connections within and between various contexts with considerable effectiveness.	The student makes connections within and between various contexts with a high degree of effectiveness.
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Requirements for Strand A

Learning and assessment related to the expectations in Strand A occur within the context of learning related to the other strands in the course. Student achievement of the expectations in Strand A is to be assessed and evaluated throughout the course and may be included in the comment section of the report card.

Criteria and Descriptors for Business Studies, Grades 9 and 10

To guide teachers in their assessment and evaluation of student learning, the achievement chart provides “criteria” and “descriptors” within each of the four categories of knowledge and skills.

A set of criteria is identified for each category in the achievement chart. The criteria are subsets of the knowledge and skills that define the category. The criteria identify the aspects of student performance that are assessed and/or evaluated, and they serve as a guide to what teachers look for. In the Grade 9 and 10 business studies curriculum, the criteria for each category are as follows:

Knowledge and Understanding

- knowledge of content (e.g., facts, terms, definitions, processes)
- understanding of content (e.g., concepts, principles, theories, processes, and technologies)

Thinking

- use of planning skills (e.g., focusing research, gathering information, generating ideas, selecting strategies, organizing projects, developing plans)
- use of processing skills (e.g., analyzing, interpreting, assessing, reasoning, selecting digital tools and technologies, evaluating, integrating, synthesizing, examining a variety of perspectives, seeking feedback, forming conclusions)
- use of critical/creative thinking processes (e.g., evaluation of business situations and ideas, problem solving, learning from feedback and research, ethical decision making, detecting bias)

Communication

- expression and organization of ideas and information (e.g., clear expression, logical organization, appropriate design) in oral, non-verbal, visual, and/or written forms, including digital and media forms (e.g., presentations, charts, graphs, tables, maps, prototypes, storyboards, web pages, spreadsheets, online networks, financial statements, letters, memos, reports)
- communication for different audiences (e.g., team members; business partners, managers, and leaders; diverse communities) and purposes (e.g., to inform, to persuade, to inspire, to motivate) in oral, non-verbal, visual, and/or written forms, including digital and media forms
- use of conventions, vocabulary, and terminology of the discipline in oral, non-verbal, visual, and/or written forms, including digital and media forms

Application

- application of knowledge and skills (e.g., concepts, processes, ethical standards, use of digital tools and technologies) in familiar contexts
- transfer of knowledge and skills (e.g., selection and use of digital tools and technologies, ethical standards, concepts, processes) to new contexts
- making connections within and between various contexts (e.g., connections between business studies and personal experiences, career opportunities, community and global challenges and perspectives; cross-curricular and multidisciplinary connections)

“Descriptors” indicate the characteristics of the student’s performance, with respect to a particular criterion, on which assessment or evaluation is focused. *Effectiveness* is the descriptor used for each of the criteria in the Thinking, Communication, and Application categories. What constitutes effectiveness in any given performance task will vary with the particular criterion being considered. Assessment of effectiveness may therefore focus on a quality such as appropriateness, clarity, accuracy, precision, logic, relevance, significance, fluency, flexibility, depth, or breadth, as appropriate for the particular criterion.

Expectations by Strand

A. Business Leadership, Project Management, and Connections

Overall expectations

Throughout this course, in connection with the learning in strands B to D, students will:

A1. Business Leadership and Project Management

demonstrate an understanding of various business leadership styles and use a [project management process](#) when performing business-related tasks

Specific expectations

Throughout this course, in connection with the learning in strands B to D, students will:

A1.1 compare various business leadership styles and explain why it might be appropriate to use a particular style in a particular situation

A1.2 use a project management process to manage the main aspects of a business project, including goals, key performance indicators, resources, delegation of tasks and responsibilities, progress of tasks, deadlines, and risks, while demonstrating a leadership style appropriate to each situation

A1.3 evaluate tasks and projects on a regular basis in terms of goals, key performance indicators, and outcomes, taking into account feedback gathered from a variety of sources

A2. Business Technologies

demonstrate an understanding of business-related digital technologies and use them in a way that respects their own and others' online safety and data security to complete a variety of business-related tasks and projects

Specific expectations

Throughout this course, in connection with the learning in strands B to D, students will:

A2.1 identify a variety of existing and emerging digital technologies, tools, and applications designed to support the completion of various business-related tasks and projects

A2.2 analyze and compare the benefits, limitations, costs, and risks, including risks to online safety and data security, associated with various digital technologies, tools, and applications used to complete business-related tasks and projects

A2.3 select and use the most appropriate digital technologies, tools, and applications to complete a variety of business-related tasks and projects

A3. Connections, Applications, and Careers

analyze how business skills and knowledge can be applied in other subject areas and in a variety of careers

Specific expectations

Throughout this course, in connection with the learning in strands B to D, students will:

A3.1 describe ways in which problem solving and creative and critical thinking can be applied to address local and global real-world opportunities and challenges

A3.2 analyze and explain how business skills and knowledge, including financial literacy, can support learning in other subject areas, in-school job skills programs, and community-based programs

A3.3 describe how their learning in this course can be applied in a variety of careers, including self-employment, entrepreneurship, or skilled trades

A3.4 create and maintain a portfolio that illustrates their business competencies and growth as an entrepreneur

A4. Contributions of Entrepreneurs

describe how entrepreneurs contribute to social, economic, and environmental progress, and analyze challenges that they face, identifying ways to address these challenges

Specific expectations

Throughout this course, in connection with the learning in strands B to D, students will:

A4.1 describe ways in which different entrepreneurial ventures have addressed social, economic, environmental, and ethical issues

A4.2 describe the contributions and impacts of successful entrepreneurs from diverse local, Canadian, and global communities

A4.3 analyze challenges faced by entrepreneurs from various communities, and identify supports available to help address these challenges

B. Economic Foundations

Overall expectations

By the end of this course, students will:

B1. Market Forces

demonstrate an understanding of how businesses respond to market forces, including supply and demand, and the needs and wants of consumers

Specific expectations

By the end of this course, students will:

B1.1 explain how market forces affect the supply, demand, and price of goods and services and economic cycles

B1.2 describe how the needs and wants of consumers and the scarcity and choice of goods and services impact consumer behaviour and how businesses respond to that behaviour

B1.3 describe how various groups in Canada have been affected by current and past market forces beyond their control

B2. The Competitive Market Environment in Canada

demonstrate an understanding of the competitive market environment in Canada and the ways in which economic systems, trade relationships, and governments influence it

Specific expectations

By the end of this course, students will:

B2.1 analyze how different competitive market structures affect business activities in Canada

B2.2 describe how trade relationships Canada has with other countries have an impact on Canadian markets and on Canadian business activities and decisions

B2.3 explain how different levels of government in Canada, as well as non-governmental bodies, may intervene in an attempt to correct market failures and to create a more fair, competitive, and responsible market environment

B3. Business in Canada

demonstrate an understanding of the various types of businesses that compose Canada's economy, and analyze the effect of their activity and innovation on communities and domestic and global economies

Specific expectations

By the end of this course, students will:

B3.1 describe the different types of businesses in Canada and their role in domestic and global economies

B3.2 compare the actions taken and innovations made by various Canadian businesses to become more socially and environmentally responsible

B3.3 analyze the ways in which various Canadian businesses are working with Indigenous entrepreneurs, businesses, or organizations, as well as First Nations, Métis, and Inuit individuals or communities, and describe how this contributes to reconciliation

C. Entrepreneurship: From Mindset to Venture

Overall expectations

By the end of this course, students will:

C1. The Entrepreneurial Mindset: Designing, Refining, and Pitching an Idea

develop, refine, and pitch an entrepreneurial idea by using design, problem solving, and pitch processes as well as an [entrepreneurial mindset](#)

Specific expectations

By the end of this course, students will:

C1.1 describe what constitutes an entrepreneurial mindset, and how their own lived experiences can help them to create and innovate new products or services

C1.2 use a design process to identify how to meet a market need or opportunity; select and develop an entrepreneurial idea to pursue; and create a prototype that takes into account the end-user experience

C1.3 use a problem solving process to assess and refine their entrepreneurial idea and prototype, considering social, economic, environmental, and ethical impacts

C1.4 use a pitch process to effectively communicate their entrepreneurial idea to various audiences for the purpose of gathering support for a potential entrepreneurial venture

C2. Planning an Entrepreneurial Venture

identify and plan the various components necessary for their entrepreneurial venture's development, and evaluate the feasibility of their venture throughout the planning process

Specific expectations

By the end of this course, students will:

C2.1 identify key performance indicators for their venture to measure its progress and success

C2.2 consider the target market and competition for their venture, and create a brand that captures its personality and identity

C2.3 identify the logistics, resources, and requirements needed for their entrepreneurial venture in order to assess its feasibility

C2.4 calculate their venture's start-up budget and conduct a break-even analysis to ensure their venture's financial viability

C3. Financing and Launching an Entrepreneurial Venture

launch an entrepreneurial venture by identifying funding opportunities and sales strategies that will help them to achieve their goals and key performance indicators

Specific expectations

By the end of this course, students will:

C3.1 identify and compare various supports, including funding opportunities, available for entrepreneurs in their community to help them launch a venture

C3.2 launch an entrepreneurial venture and lead it towards achieving their identified goals and key performance indicators

C3.3 analyze ethical sales strategies and respectful, accessible customer service approaches and apply them to their entrepreneurial venture

D. Business Functions

Overall expectations

By the end of this course, students will:

D1. Operations

demonstrate an understanding of the processes involved in producing a product or delivering a service, and develop a process for producing their product or delivering their service, identifying ways to improve the process overall

Specific expectations

By the end of this course, students will:

D1.1 describe the processes involved in the production of a product or the delivery of a service

D1.2 examine and evaluate how various businesses have enhanced the efficiency, health and safety practices, ethics, and sustainability of their production or delivery processes

D1.3 outline a process for producing their product or delivering their service in an efficient, healthy, safe, ethical, and sustainable way

D2. Marketing

demonstrate an understanding of the “three Cs” (company, customer, and competition) and the “four Ps” (product, price, place, and promotion), including how different strategies can be used in different markets

Specific expectations

By the end of this course, students will:

D2.1 analyze how various businesses have successfully used different marketing strategies for different target markets

D2.2 create a mission statement based on the unique selling proposition and brand values of their entrepreneurial venture

D2.3 explain how their venture is best suited for their target customer and how it distinguishes itself from the competition through its value proposition and competitive advantages

D2.4 describe the four Ps of marketing, including how they complement each other to attract customers, and create a marketing mix for their entrepreneurial venture

D3. Accounting

demonstrate an understanding of the role and importance of accounting to the entrepreneurial process and to the development and growth of a small business

Specific expectations

By the end of this course, students will:

D3.1 explain the role and importance of both financial and management accounting for a business in decision making and in building transparency and trust, internally and externally

D3.2 demonstrate an understanding of tracking cash inflows and outflows for a small business and the responsibility of reporting on performance

D3.3 analyze basic financial statements for a small business to determine its financial position and performance

D3.4 demonstrate an understanding of the role and importance of non-financial reporting and how it helps to communicate their venture's impact and commitment to responsible practices

D4. Management of Human Resources

demonstrate an understanding of the role of management in supporting a team of employees, including a manager's ethical, moral, and legal responsibilities and considerations

Specific expectations

By the end of this course, students will:

D4.1 explain the role of management in leading others in a business, including a manager's ethical, moral, and legal responsibilities and considerations

D4.2 demonstrate how to manage human resource issues that might arise in a business, including ethical issues related to employees, the environment, and communities

Resources

[Key Changes – Business Studies, Grades 9 and 10](#)

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Information for parents

[A parent's guide to Business Studies, Grades 9 and 10 \(2024\)](#)

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